THE LEDGER

MULTI-CLUB OWNERSHIP BUILT AN INVISIBLE TRANSFER LOOPHOLE.

How the big groups move value around the rules.

A **5**–part breakdown

SWIPE

0101 / 05

IT IS EVERYWHERE.

A large share of Europe’s top clubs now sit in multi-club groups. *Not synergy. Accounting.*

0202 / 05

THE EXPLOIT.

Buy talent through a smaller affiliate, in a cheaper or looser league. Develop it off the main books. ***Costs parked elsewhere.***

0303 / 05

THE VALUATION TRICK.

When the player is ready, move him to the flagship at a soft ‘internal value’. ***Market inflation, skipped.***

0404 / 05

THE WALL.

UEFA now runs fair-value checks on sister-club deals. But loan-fee inflation and cross-sponsorship are hard to police. ***Oversight lags the structure.***

0505 / 05

THE FLOW, SIMPLIFIED.

One holding company. Three clubs. A player’s book value drops as he moves toward the flagship. *Value engineered down.*

THE TAKEAWAY

FAIR, OR BROKEN?

Save this for the window. Does multi-club ownership wreck integrity, or is it just corporate evolution? Tell us — follow @thearchv_ca.

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